



Short Answer Questions

1. Define ethics.
Ans: Ethics is the branch of philosophy that studies moral principles and values that guide human behavior. It helps individuals determine what is right or wrong and what actions are morally acceptable in society.
2. What is ethical reasoning?
Ans: Ethical reasoning is the process of analyzing a situation using moral principles and values to determine the most ethical course of action. It involves evaluating consequences, duties, and fairness before making decisions.
3. Explain the functional definition of ethics.
Ans: The functional definition of ethics refers to the practical role ethics plays in guiding behavior and decision-making in society. It helps individuals and organizations follow moral standards and act responsibly toward others.
4. What are ethical theories?
Ans: Ethical theories are systematic frameworks used to determine what is morally right or wrong. They provide principles and guidelines for analyzing ethical issues and making moral decisions.
5. Define utilitarianism.
Ans: Utilitarianism is an ethical theory that states that the best action is the one that produces the greatest happiness or benefit for the greatest number of people.
6. What is deontological ethics?
Ans: Deontological ethics is a moral theory that focuses on duties, rules, and obligations. According to this theory, an action is considered ethical if it follows moral rules, regardless of the consequences.
7. What is virtue ethics?
Ans: Virtue ethics is an ethical theory that emphasizes moral character and virtues such as honesty, courage, and kindness rather than focusing only on rules or consequences.
8. What is ethical decision making?
Ans: Ethical decision making is the process of choosing the best action based on moral principles, values, and consideration of the impact on others.
9. What is a code of ethics?
Ans: A code of ethics is a set of principles and guidelines that define acceptable behavior for members of a profession or organization. It helps ensure honesty, responsibility, and integrity.
10. Why are codes of ethics important in professional fields?
Ans: Codes of ethics guide professionals in maintaining integrity, responsibility, and accountability. They help build trust, promote ethical conduct, and protect the interests of society.
11. What is computer ethics?
Ans: Computer ethics is the study of moral issues and responsibilities related to the use of computers and information technology, including privacy, security, and intellectual property.
12. List two ethical issues in computing.
Ans: Two common ethical issues in computing are:
 - Violation of data privacy
 - Software piracy

13. What is meant by ethical analysis?

Ans: Ethical analysis is the process of examining a situation to identify moral issues, evaluate different options, and determine the most ethical course of action.

14. Define ethical dilemma.

Ans: An ethical dilemma is a situation where a person must choose between two or more conflicting moral principles, making it difficult to decide the correct action.

15. Explain the relationship between technology and values.

Ans: Technology and values are closely related because technology influences how people live, work, and communicate. At the same time, human values guide how technology is developed and used responsibly.

Long Answer Questions

1. Define ethics and explain its importance in society

Ans: **Ethics** is a branch of **Philosophy** that deals with moral principles and values which guide human behavior. It helps individuals decide what is right or wrong, good or bad, and acceptable or unacceptable in society. Ethics provides rules and standards that influence how people behave toward others.

Importance of Ethics in Society:

1. **Promotes Moral Values:**

Ethics encourages values such as honesty, integrity, fairness, and responsibility among individuals.

2. **Maintains Social Order:**

Ethical principles help create discipline and harmony in society by guiding people to follow acceptable behavior.

3. **Builds Trust and Respect:**

When people act ethically, it builds trust, cooperation, and mutual respect among members of society.

4. **Guides Decision Making:**

Ethics helps individuals and organizations make fair and responsible decisions in difficult situations.

5. **Prevents Harm and Injustice:**

Ethical standards protect people from exploitation, discrimination, and unfair treatment.

6. **Encourages Professional Conduct:**

In fields like business, medicine, and technology, ethical practices ensure accountability and responsible actions.

Conclusion:

Ethics plays a vital role in shaping human behavior and maintaining peace, justice, and cooperation in society. It helps individuals live responsibly and contributes to the overall well-being and progress of the community.

2. Discuss different ethical theories with examples

Ans: Ethical theories provide frameworks to determine what is morally right or wrong. Some major ethical theories are:

1. **Utilitarianism**

This theory states that the best action is the one that produces the greatest good for the greatest number of people.

Example: A government implementing policies that benefit the majority of citizens.

2. **Deontological Theory (Duty-Based Ethics)**

This theory emphasizes that actions are morally right if they follow rules or duties regardless of consequences.

Example: A person telling the truth even if it causes problems because honesty is a moral duty.

3. **Virtue Ethics**

This theory focuses on the character and virtues of a person rather than specific actions.

Example: A teacher showing kindness, patience, and fairness toward students.

4. **Rights-Based Ethics**

It emphasizes protecting the fundamental rights and freedoms of individuals.

Example: Respecting a person's right to privacy when handling personal data.

These theories help individuals and organizations make ethical decisions in various situations.

3. Explain the concept of ethical reasoning and decision making

Ans: **Ethical reasoning** is the process of evaluating actions and decisions based on moral principles and values. It helps individuals determine what is right or wrong in a particular situation.

Ethical decision making involves selecting the best possible action after considering ethical principles, consequences, and responsibilities.

Steps in Ethical Decision Making

1. Identify the ethical problem.
2. Gather relevant information.
3. Consider possible alternatives.
4. Evaluate alternatives based on ethical principles.
5. Choose the best ethical action.
6. Implement and review the decision.

Example: A software developer deciding whether to report a security flaw in a system even if it may delay the project.

Ethical reasoning ensures responsible behavior and promotes fairness and justice in society.

4. Describe the functional definition of ethics with examples

Ans: The **functional definition of ethics** explains ethics as a system of rules, standards, and values that guide human behavior and help maintain social order.

According to this view, ethics functions as a guide for decision-making and helps individuals distinguish between right and wrong actions.

Examples

1. **Business Ethics:** Companies follow fair practices in trade and avoid misleading customers.
2. **Medical Ethics:** Doctors maintain patient confidentiality and provide proper treatment.
3. **Computer Ethics:** IT professionals respect data privacy and avoid software piracy.

Thus, the functional definition emphasizes how ethical principles operate in real-life situations to regulate human actions.

5. Explain the role and importance of codes of ethics in professional life

Ans: A **code of ethics** is a set of principles and guidelines that help professionals conduct their work responsibly and ethically.

Role of Codes of Ethics

1. **Guidance for Professional Behavior:** Provides standards for acceptable conduct.
2. **Promotes Integrity and Honesty:** Encourages ethical practices in the workplace.
3. **Protects Public Interest:** Ensures professionals act responsibly toward society.

4. **Improves Trust:** Builds confidence among clients, employers, and the public.
5. **Prevents Misconduct:** Reduces unethical activities and professional malpractice.

Example

An IT professional must protect user data and maintain confidentiality while working with sensitive information.

Codes of ethics help maintain professionalism, accountability, and credibility in different professions.

6. Discuss the concept of computer ethics and its significance in the modern digital world

Ans: **Computer ethics** refers to the moral principles and guidelines that govern the use of computers, information systems, and digital technologies.

It deals with issues such as privacy, intellectual property, data security, and responsible use of technology.

Significance of Computer Ethics

1. **Protection of Privacy:** Ensures personal information is not misused.
2. **Prevention of Cybercrime:** Discourages hacking, fraud, and identity theft.
3. **Responsible Use of Technology:** Promotes ethical behavior while using digital tools.
4. **Protection of Intellectual Property:** Prevents illegal copying of software and digital content.
5. **Maintains Trust in Technology:** Encourages safe and reliable use of computer systems.

In today's digital age, computer ethics is essential for maintaining responsible and lawful use of technology.

7. Explain various ethical issues related to computer technology

Ans: Computer technology has created many ethical challenges. Some major ethical issues include:

1. **Privacy Issues:** Unauthorized access to personal data.
2. **Intellectual Property Rights:** Illegal copying or distribution of software and digital content.
3. **Cybercrime:** Activities like hacking, phishing, and identity theft.
4. **Data Security:** Protecting information from unauthorized access or misuse.
5. **Digital Divide:** Unequal access to technology among different groups of people.
6. **Online Harassment:** Cyberbullying and misuse of social media.

Addressing these issues is important to ensure responsible use of computer technology.

8. Discuss how technology influences human values and society

Ans: Technology plays a significant role in shaping human values and societal behavior.

Positive Influences

1. **Improved Communication:** Instant communication through the internet and mobile devices.
2. **Access to Information:** Easy access to knowledge and education.
3. **Better Healthcare:** Use of technology in medical diagnosis and treatment.

Negative Influences

1. **Privacy Concerns:** Personal data may be exposed online.
2. **Dependence on Technology:** Excessive reliance on digital devices.
3. **Reduced Human Interaction:** Less face-to-face communication.

Technology influences culture, lifestyle, work environments, and ethical standards in society.

9. Explain the process of ethical analysis with suitable examples

Ans: **Ethical analysis** is a systematic method used to evaluate ethical problems and determine the best course of action.

Steps in Ethical Analysis

1. Identify the ethical issue.
2. Identify stakeholders involved.
3. Gather relevant facts and information.
4. Consider possible alternatives.
5. Evaluate alternatives using ethical principles.
6. Choose and implement the most ethical solution.

Example

A company collects user data without informing customers. Ethical analysis would involve identifying privacy concerns, considering user rights, and deciding to implement transparent data policies.

Ethical analysis helps individuals and organizations resolve ethical dilemmas responsibly.

10. Discuss the importance of ethics in the field of information technology

Ans: Ethics plays a crucial role in the field of information technology because IT professionals handle sensitive data and powerful digital systems.

Importance of Ethics in IT

1. **Protection of User Data:** Ensures confidentiality and privacy of information.
2. **Responsible Software Development:** Developers must create secure and reliable systems.
3. **Prevention of Cybercrime:** Ethical conduct discourages illegal activities.
4. **Maintaining Professional Integrity:** IT professionals must act honestly and responsibly.
5. **Compliance with Laws:** Ethical practices ensure adherence to legal regulations.

Ethics helps maintain trust, security, and fairness in the rapidly growing IT industry.